

that might not give you the full feature set that the proprietary ones do, but are more than enough for everyday use, and sometimes good enough for professional use as well. Let's talk about some of the alternatives out there.

OPEN SOURCE SOFTWARE

Ardour

Platform: Mac, Linux

Ardour is an amazing DAS that can handle all kinds of tasks. Although it isn't even close to as expensive as some of the earlier mentioned software (we'll get to the pricing in a bit), it has a beautiful interface and packs some real recording power. It's the Open Source go to software for musicians, engineers,



Ardour - This power-packed application has an interesting pay-as-you-please model

soundtrack editors and composers. Ardour can record audio from multiple inputs and has a huge set of features that could very well produce some high quality audio files depending on your skills. The only downside to this is that it isn't the easiest software to pick up, and it might just be too much for users trying to create simple sound recordings or podcasts. Ardour also has a very good ecosystem with hundreds of plug-ins available for download. The best part about Ardour, however, is that it's a pay-as-you-please product. However, if you do decide to pay nothing, there's a penalty – no customer support for Linux users, and Mac users won't be able to save Audiounit plug-in settings.

LMMS

Platform: Windows, Linux

The name Linux Multi Media Studio (LMMS) is pretty misleading as it works on both, Windows and Linux. LMMS is targeted at songwriters, and offers a beat editor and an FX mixer. LMMS has such a vast array of instruments that you'll be able to



LMMS - The name might be misleading as it runs on Windows as well